

THERE'S NOTHING LIKE THIS.

HEATHER KNIGHT
WORLD CUP WINNING CAPTAIN

Red-letter day: India and England played the first-ever women's Test at Lord's between July 10 and 13. PICS: P. K. AJITH KUMAR

Tales from the tube and beyond

Our correspondent gathers **vignettes** from an English summer, from ticket touts outside Lord's and cricket on the London Tube to memories of radio commentary and chance encounters on the road.

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Isa Guha smiles, almost triumphantly, when you tell her that you came across a couple of touts outside St. John's Wood underground station on the day of the Women's T20 World Cup final. "The tickets are sold out, you know," one of them shouted as passengers crossed the road and headed towards Lord's. You asked

him the price. "Seventy pounds," he said. The actual cost of the ticket was 20 pounds.

Isa, a World Cup-winning England seamer turned commentator, says, "There you go." She admits she could not have imagined such a situation in her time as a player.

A couple of days later, Isa's former England teammate, Tammy

Beaumont, at a press conference ahead of the first-ever Women's Test at Lord's, gives you an even clearer picture of the growth in interest in women's cricket. "I made my debut in front of five people besides the ground men and now we will be playing a Test match potentially in front of 20,000," she says as she addresses the media shortly after